



Paramedic Ants

Ants have been observed not only rescuing injured ants but even cleaning wounds and possibly administering anti-biotics. <http://digit.in/parant>



Heated jacket

A kickstarter by Ministry of Supply has a jacket that intelligently heats up to your optimal temperature. <http://digit.in/MansNotHot>

"What the hell's going on?"

That's when they noticed that everybody was staring at the sky in a kind of a trance. And it was getting darker. A darkness that would soon engulf them and become a part of everybody's lives.

As the trio looked up, they saw an unimaginable sight- the sun was fading. Similar to an eclipse but the black patch was not moving in from a direction. The sun was just fading, like a bulb beyond its years.

As the darkness spread, chaos erupted. Horns blaring, everybody running helter skelter, children crying, a woman wailing, "It's the end of days! Judgement day is here!"

This wasn't supposed to happen, Theta thought flashing back to his graduation astrophysics class. Not for billions of years at least. And even if it did, it would expand and go supernova consuming Mercury, Venus and Earth in its insatiable hunger, not go dark!

"Let's go!", Theta shouted, herding Xena and Omi to his Espai. "I sure am glad I chose the electric charged model and not the solar powered one" he chuckled getting into the driver seat at an attempt at false bravado to keep up the spirits of the blabbering Xena and stupefied Omi.

WAKING UP

Theta paused as he stood outside the Hawaiian Cafe. He still liked meeting his friends but he wasn't a fan of their new found ideology. To be fair, it wasn't just them- the world had discovered a new religion and everybody was on the bandwagon. The Solaroids, as they were known, were the new Gods. Living, breathing, walking gods. Well, floating really. Their home planet was mainly water so they had devised a hovering craft that floated just a few inches off the ground. They were always on those hovercrafts, so much so that some people speculated that they couldn't really use their legs. This was, of course, whispered only to close confidants, making sure they could not be overheard. Any word against them was blasphemy. Everybody seemed to have forgotten life before them, before the sun blacked out.

They made their appearance after 3 months of despair and devastation had wrecked the surface of the earth. Humans had become so inured to the law of the jungle that even the presence of alien life form, intelligent creatures from outer space hardly made a blip in the daily scheme of things.

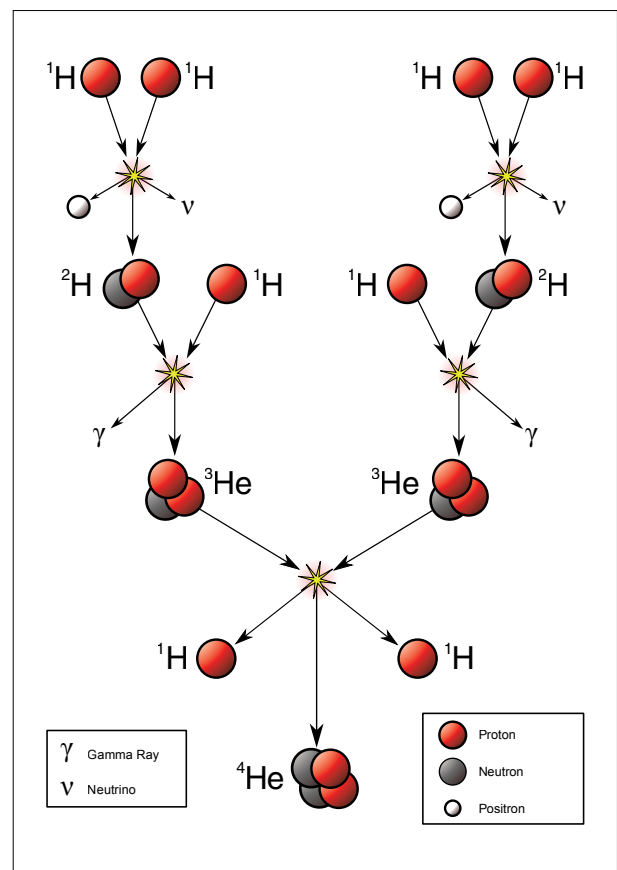
Theta glanced at the 'sun' hanging in the sky, in the stratosphere really, a paltry image of the primordial force of nature. A 10SM it was called referring to the 10% solar efficiency of the original sun's magnitude. Their "gift" to earth as everybody called it overlooking the deal the world had made with them. You give us sun, we will give you cheap labour to build machines for you to take back to your planet. He hated the blob from the bottom of his heart. It could not sustain his vegetable and fruit garden. His secret. He hated the food pills as much as he hated the 10SM and the solaroids.

He took a deep breath and entered the cafe. He noticed Xena and Omi at the center table. "Their tech is just amazing,

they are light years ahead of what we could ever have done", she was saying to Omi as he nodded along. Theta didn't have to ask who "they" are, he knew. Sadly, his friends also had given in to the new ideology.

Theta decided to take a risk. "Hey do you guys remember how the sun shone and the world was a different place before it all went to shit?" Xena gave him a odd look and Omi shuffled his feet uneasily. "Duh, it was different. Crime rates increasing, global warming it sure was a different shitty place", Xena replied. "Yep, it's our fortune that the Solaroids came along", Omi chimed in.

Theta took a deep breath and took the plunge. "Ya, it was. It was a horrid place. These guys sure did save us. I wish I could



How the sun works, turning Hydrogen into Helium

more than just pay the solar taxes. I need to show my gratitude. There is so much I can do at the solar factory". He felt sick, nauseous. But it had to be done. He had to jump on the bandwagon too. He had to, in order to destroy this sham from the inside.

Enthusiastically, Omi said, "Oh ya, ya there is so much you can do. You are the smartest physicist I know. Actually, you are the smartest guy I know. I can get you in, easy peasy. I am the secretary for the chief engineer at the solar plant and you can definitely join the team. I will talk to my boss tomorrow itself".

"I am sorry my friend", thought Theta. He hated the deception of his closest buddies, but there was more than a friendship at stake here.